

Our Strength Is in His Grace

Because I have truly been asking my Father to go where I have never been before, consequently I am having the privilege of seeing into things of the Spirit that I have never seen before. And although there are the pros, there are also the cons. Things are being exposed in me that I never knew were there before.

It seems that all of it is a necessary process to the end. Jesus said:

| If ye love me, keep my commandments.

He also said:

| Every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

If we are fruit bearers, then we can look gladly with great anticipation toward being purged so that we might bear more. In fact, He said:

| Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

Once again, that is the finality we will be judged by in the last days.

He has promised me that if I bear fruit and want fruit, He will purge me so that I bear more. That is all right. But the purging process is cutting off dead limbs. It seems that to produce more, we have to lose. I do not mind.

But along with seeing more, I am being purged more. And along with this purging, evidently it is necessary that I become more acquainted with my enemy, because He said I should not be ignorant of his devices, which I fully intend not to be.

To go where I have never been before, things will try to stop me that have never tried before. Things are being revealed that I never knew were there before. But it is great.

As we take this a step further, we have been studying revival, and it is inevitable that in the study of revival He pulls us around to grace. To stand up against this foe that we are called to stand up against, especially in these last days, the church of God, of whom we are a part, must have a fuller and fuller understanding of grace.

Even though He is taking me in a slightly different direction tonight, this much we must know at this point: if there was ever a man worthy of all the wiles the enemy could muster, connive, scheme, and employ to stop one man, that would have to be the apostle Paul.

Paul outlined the war when he said we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities and powers. It is the same war of casting down imaginations and every high thing in this attack that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, with the audacity to replace that knowledge, and bringing into captivity every thought.

This war raged through the thing I could not get past in 2 Corinthians 12. If there was ever a description of this war raging against the apostle Paul, it would have to be when Paul said, "There was given to me a thorn in the flesh because of my abundance of revelation."

That has to be the most descriptive account of a war ever fought by powers and principalities to stop one man. Yet it is recorded.

The most fascinating thing about this war that I have found to this day is that a man of Paul's caliber did not miss a trick. A man responsible for recording grace, a man of this caliber of understanding and revelation knowledge, still had to seek God three times before God was able to get this over to him:

My grace is sufficient for thee.

Three times. It makes me wonder how many attempts He has made on my life to get grace over to me if it took three for Paul. Paul finally said:

For this thing I besought the Lord thrice...

Three times I sought God, and He said, "My grace is sufficient." Three times.

It makes me know that contained within this grace, which we have so affectionately labeled the unmerited, unearnable favor of God bestowed upon us, is something tremendous. It means I could not merit it, earn it, or deserve it.

In fact, He said all boasting has been excluded by grace. You cannot earn it no matter how hard you work, no matter how much you do for the kingdom, and not even by how much you give.

Work earns you nothing. It was not until I had fallen in love with Him enough to stand in His presence and reverse the whole order that I could say, "I do not work because I am afraid of You. I do not work because I can make You love me any more. I do not work to earn Your favor. I do not work to put You under some kind of obligation to me that will force You to move on my behalf."

The word grace makes all of that an absolute impossibility.

Grace is so phenomenal. What we could not earn, did not merit, and did not deserve was suddenly freely offered to us. He had to label a certain force that was not used that much in the Old Testament until Hebrews 11 labeled the great annals of faith and said what those men in the Old Testament were doing were exploits by faith, Abraham being the father of it all.

Yet this force used so much in the New Testament is simply called faith.

At times it can almost seem frustrating. We have a word for an invisible force that carries us into the presence of God. Romans 5 labels it:

Therefore being justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ:
By whom also we have access by faith into this grace wherein we stand...

We have access into this grace wherein we stand by faith. Before the foundations of the world, in the mind of God, to the day of the cross when He purchased the standing for me, I have this force by which I approach that standing. I cannot obtain it any other way.

Sometimes it almost feels frustrating, because if you put a hammer in my hand and give me a nail, I can drive the nail. If you give me lumber, I can build a house. If you tell me to kill a bullock and shed its blood, there is something physical I can do, some kind of works, where I can leave that point behind me and say with my mouth, "I have done it. I am clean."

No. We have this invisible force to contend with. And as frustrating as it may seem, my friend, there is only one way you can access grace: you must have enough faith to stand up and say, "No, I did not earn it. I did not merit it. But He is offering it to me."

As frustrating as it may seem from time to time, there is only one way I can appropriate His standing to my life. I must simply believe it. I must simply believe it.

I had several things outlined, but when the well opens, I can do nothing else until it is over.

Here we have this force. It is the only force in the universe that makes His standing accessible in my life. That should make us want to know a little more about it, wouldn't you say?

Faith is the ability to believe that which does not exist in the tangible.

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

My faith is all the evidence of the thing I do not yet see. What an incredible force. And even more incredible than this force is the standing I apprehend, which is grace.

We have been forced into a position to believe in grace as far as heaven is concerned, have we not? After all, you have to believe heaven exists. If you do not, where are you going?

Death is an everyday present reality that we have to reconcile. He said we see all things put under His feet, but as of yet we do not see all things. Yes, positionally He has defeated death. But death is the last sting before victory, and it is inevitable. Everyone around us is dying. We lose our relatives to it. A person becomes ever more aware as age increases.

Regardless, we must hold grace up before us and believe that heaven is. It is. And very shortly, by God's standards, it will be our home.

Our faith has accessed grace to that degree because there is nothing we can do about it except believe we are going. We believe one day I will be glorified, that my body will not see its permanent resting place six feet under the ground. I do believe I am not going to rest there. I believe I am going to be working like crazy one day, and I will hear a trumpet.

Because that is a future event, we have apprehended it by faith, and it has become part of our everyday living.

But evidently Jesus wanted to pull grace into a realm of ever-presence. Grace is a viable, pliable force available for our lives and in our lives in everyday situations. It is not just that we rejoice because our faith has obtained grace and we know heaven is our home. Paul said we rejoice in tribulations also, because tribulation works patience, experience, and hope.

Pulling grace into the everyday affairs of this life by faith will cause you to experience the same kind of power of deliverance Paul experienced.

God had to tell him three times in the middle of what Paul labeled as a messenger straight from the throne room of hell, on assignment to bring his ministry to a standstill because he was causing the kind of revival that had never been caused by a man in the history of the church.

This assurance I do have: the same weaponry available to him is available to me. Should I ever be blessed by God enough to contend with and face the same strong man Paul faced, I consider that worth shouting over more than anything I have ever laid my hands on.

You could not be worthy of such a visitation unless you were also worthy to be stopped.

I am not saying this to shake your world up. I am past that. I am not trying to bring condemnation on you or cause your life to be full of torment because you feel you are not fulfilling all the obligations Christ has called you and me to fulfill.

That is not my purpose. My purpose is to fulfill the call He separated me to since before the foundations of the world.

He said, "If you love Me, keep My commandments." If you love Him, that would also be the purpose of your call.

You say, "Well, I do not want to hear that part of the Word. I do not want you to reveal these things."

It does not matter. You are still going to be judged, not by Jesus, but by the words He has spoken in the last days. Whether you were too lazy to dig them out or not does not change it.

"Leave me alone."

What are you saying? Are you an ostrich? You bury your head in the sand and it all goes away? Does that make revival for our generation any less available? No.

My purpose is to fully fulfill what Christ has separated me to, as He has separated you to from before the foundations of the world. Should I someday be accounted worthy to be stopped, I will consider that worth shouting over, more than anything else that has ever happened to me besides my name being written in the Lamb's Book of Life and my privilege to prostrate myself on the altar, offering my body as a living sacrifice, that I may stand before Him in that last day and hear, "Well done, My good and faithful servant."

Should that day come, then I will gladly take the same equipment. When perverse and backward circumstances come, when perplexities and necessities come, perhaps as when God moved through me in prophecy that this war in the last day makes it to our soil, wake up.

Even by Bible standards, there are people in other lands who would swear to God they are in the middle of the Tribulation, starving to death while the world contends for power.

If you will remember the prophecy, be aware: the peace, peace, peace; the walls come down; Russia is opened up. Yes, thank You, Father, that is one side of the coin. But the other side is sudden destruction. We are on the brink of World War IV. On the brink.

Perhaps our soil turns red from our sons' blood. And you stand and say our theologians were wrong. If that day comes, I will be no more stoppable than I am now, nor should you be.

Perplexities. Necessities. Perils of false brethren. Perils of thieves. Perils of robbers. A night and a day in the deep. Three times forty lashes save one.

They say Jesus had to be strong to survive Jewish-law lashings, that forty could kill a man and you would become vile. That is why they stayed under the law and gave thirty-nine. They said Jesus had to be strong to survive this, yet Paul survived three beatings.

In hungers and thirsts forced upon him, in fastings often by his own will. Going where no man should go. Being stoned and left for dead. Instead of going home, visiting heaven and coming back.

Five times they tied him up, put his feet in stocks, and beat his feet with rods until they bloodied the nerve endings. Yet after three times, he stood up and said hell did not have enough.

Powers and principalities, spiritual wickedness in high places, and rulers of the darkness of this present world stood up and schemed and connived and incited every crowd that ever lived to kill him.

It may have taken three times, but he got it. He said, "Do you want to know what He said to me? He said, 'My grace.' He said, 'My grace.'"

Oh, there is a great reward on the other side of the graduations of the devil's onslaughts. Every time you jump a hurdle, my God, there is more reward on the other side than you can shake a stick at. Not only when you get to heaven, but in present results, where your eyes feast and your spirit revels in glories, because the foe is unable to stop you.

How can I afford to let emotions stop me from praying? How can I afford to let tribulations stop me from praying? How can I afford anything hell has thrown at me in this realm to stop me from praying?

I must understand more. My spirit is too hungry. It is too hungry.

When He said, "My grace is sufficient," my God, what kind of statement is that? If this grace can only be accessed by faith, what are we talking about?

This standing that I could not merit, could not earn, and did not deserve is standing for my life in the middle of perversity, imprisonments, beatings, stonings, and certain death. You mean that in the middle of all this I can access His standing?

That is what He said.

Paul said:

Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.

Instead of entering into perplexity, failure of spirit, and fainting in my mind from the tribulations, I will rather glory in my infirmities. That is to say, anything the devil throws at me that in my own strength I cannot overcome, I glory in that kind of weakness.

When I am weak, then I am strong, because when I am stripped of depending on my own ability, His strength is perfected in the middle of my weakness. So my instruction for accessing grace in the worst of it is to glorify God right in the middle of it.

He said, "My grace is sufficient," and that His strength is made perfect when I am stripped of dependency on all natural avenues and flesh.

I tell you what, there is no faster way to get stripped of your own dependency than to believe the Lord your God for an outpouring of the Spirit until revival ravages your city. There is just no way to do that in the natural.

Talk about being delivered to a destitute, horrible place of incapacabilities and inabilities as far as a man's own strength is concerned. My God, I must be making the devil mad. That is all I have to say. I must be making him mad.

Yet if glorifying God in the middle of my tribulation activates grace, then that is a faith instruction. To Dave Roberson, that is an instruction of grace. It is an instruction of faith.

I am releasing faith when I stand up in the middle of my tribulations and rendered-helpless situations and glorify God.

Hallelujah. Glory. I can feel the trade-off: my strength for His, my standing for His. I can feel the trade-off.

Glory to God. I can feel the revival coming. Why? Because He is going to bring it.

I can feel the trade-off.

You do not have enough money to meet your bills. Who cares? His standing of grace is for me.

Surely He has borne my poverty. Grace is mentioned four times up to the ninth verse. Paul says, "You know the grace bestowed on the church in Macedonia," and in the great trial of affliction, according to their liberality, they came right out of it. They gave themselves, and he called it grace.

"See that you abound in this grace also."

What grace is he talking about?

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ...

Do you know it? That is what he said. Do you know the grace?

...that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

I can see no other way to access that but by faith, because He said it is my grace.

Why do you give? Not because I am trying to earn anything. I give because I know what I could not earn, He gave me. I simply give because I know that standing of wealth that extends all the way to heaven is unmerited. It is His standing, unearnable. His. He gave it to me.

If there is only one way to access that grace, it is by faith. Just like praising God in the middle of tribulations activates grace to get you delivered, giving is an instruction of faith. It activates that grace and trades your standing off for His.

Do not let anybody put you into the legalism of trying to earn something. If you are not giving because you are in love with Him, you are already in works.

I do not have to worry about disease. Surely He has borne. I did not do it any more than I bore my own poverty. I am not qualified. I am not even going to attempt it. If grace makes me rich, then I will just have to go out in history as rich. Regardless.

If the devil is putting a stop in every financial realm until it is tribulation point necessity, I could not earn it anyway. I will glorify God so loud the rafters shake until it activates a standing I could not earn. And just like Paul, I will be delivered.

Surely He has borne my sicknesses and carried my pains. If you can accept that grace, access it by faith. My friend, it is not accessible any other way. Faith is that mysterious force that you can apprehend grace with. There is no other way to get it.

You say, "I am going to play Florence Nightingale and nurse every person on the foreign field back to health." Great. That is honorable. It will not earn you His standing.

Why do I do that? Because I love Him.

Surely He has borne my sicknesses and carried my pains. There is only one way I can access that. I certainly did not merit it, earn it, or deserve it.

But when the devil is perched on your shoulder, when your body is rotting and cancer has given you no time to live, when the devil is screaming uncontrolled, uncaptivated thoughts in your eardrum - "You are going to die because you did not do this and did not do that. Remember two years ago, those tithes you did not pay? Remember those three months in that half-backslidden condition? Remember that strife and unforgiveness you got into?" - he will backlash you and take your history to convince you.

Let me tell you about the middle of tribulations and trading your standing off for His. As of three seconds ago, you do not have to be worthy. You did not have to earn it. You did not merit it. It does not matter how much unforgiveness you walked in. It does not matter how many months or years of church you missed. He can use all the case history he wants on you.

All you have to do is say, "Jesus, forgive me the whole mess, and I am going to glorify God in the face of the devil that Your grace says I am healed. I cannot earn it. I did not deserve it. I did not. Do you hear me, devil?"

You trade that puny weakness you have for His strength and watch Him trade off. You do not have to put up with it.

He was wounded for my transgressions: His side, His hands, His brow, His feet, His back. He was wounded for my transgressions.

He took it further. When He fulfilled the law, "Cursed is every man that hangeth on a tree," the law ended. But He had to take it back to Abraham's time, back to Adam's time. When Adam had the death penalty passed on him - not only him, but all mankind - Jesus became a man and suffered that death penalty.

That death penalty was not just the dying of the cross. Adam was spiritually dead. If all Adam had done was die in his physical body, then the cross alone would have been adequate, but it was not. Adam was separated from God. After the cross, Jesus went to the belly of hell, as Jonah so aptly described it.

He was wounded for my transgressions. I could do repentance until I cut my arms and legs off and do good works for God until I turned blue. All He said about corresponding actions is this: "I will show you my faith by my works." If you are born again and have faith, then you will work the works of Christ. You simply will.

But as far as works earning my salvation, I cannot. I could cut off my arms, toes, and legs. I could crawl forty-five miles on broken glass. That will do me no good, because what I am after was not accessible until He made it accessible by faith. I must simply stand up, exclude the law of works by faith, and receive freely what He has given me.

Not only was He wounded for my transgressions, He was bruised for my iniquities. Iniquities have more to do with inherited traits. Liars pass down liars. Murderers pass down murderers. Adulterers pass down adulterers. Iniquity can be an inherited weakness in the flesh.

Notice He was bruised. A bruise is an inner wound. He was bruised for my inner healings, my inherited weaknesses for sin, habitual lying, intimidations, and shortcomings. He was bruised for them.

The chastisement for my lack of peace was upon Him in the form of punishment, and with His stripes I am healed.

As far as wisdom goes, because He was brought as a lamb before the shearers, dumb, He opened not His mouth. When He stood before Pilate and was judged in my place, He refused to open His mouth in His own defense.

Why? It certainly was not because He did not have an answer. He was in the world, and the world was made by Him. The Father planned it. The mighty Logos created everything that exists. Every electron, proton, and neutron flying around every atom in your body was brought into existence the day He framed the worlds. "Framed" means the network that matter hangs upon. He created it.

Here He stood in the world, and it knew Him not. The deity of Jesus Christ knows the answer to every question that has never been asked. Yet in the leadership of the Spirit, He made this wisdom available to me.

Why? Because as my Substitute in the trial, He freely stepped into my shoes to take the punishment. He stood trial as a guiltless man and refused to open His mouth and defend Himself because He is my Substitute.

Now, when the devil pulls me and puts me on trial for the same things Jesus was tried for - sin, spiritual death, poverty - I am tried for them as guilty and having no rights before God. But because He is my Substitute and would not open His mouth and give an answer, I now, in identification, can open my mouth and have access to all the wisdom during my trial that He refused to give.

That is His standing of grace.

Is it all available, Roberson? Yes.

You believe heaven is available. What options do you have? You are dying. So what if we pulled that kind of grace into this realm? Like the apostle Paul, every time they dragged him on trial, threw him in prison, tortured him, left him for dead, and persecuted him, we could learn what

weapon we have and access this grace by faith, by glorifying God with everything in us right in the middle of tribulation.

That standing of grace cannot be earned.

This starts getting interesting.

Paul evidently operated out of the Spirit, would you say so? No wonder Hebrews 4 says:

Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest...

The only thing on God's green earth worth laboring for is to enter into the rest.

"But I am being beaten."

I do not care.

"But my money is all gone."

I do not care.

"My body is terminal."

I do not care.

"You do not understand. My husband, my wife, and everything walked out on me."

It does not matter. It does not change your standing.

"Oh, but you do not understand, Brother Roberson."

Yes, I do. The thing worth laboring for is to enter into His rest. That is what I will work the hardest for, because it is in that place of peace and rest where you and I are unstoppable, simply because our adversary cannot manage us anymore.

Why can he not manage you? Because I will not be badgered by pressure. How can he manage you? That is what he is king of: pressure.

If you will not take systems of thought and imaginations that become the high thing that unseat the knowledge of Christ, and if you will not let thoughts run away uncaptured, then the wiles of this enemy can attack you with everything in them, and He simply says, "Put the armor on."

That armor is a type of His standing. Every piece is symbolic. It is spiritual. He says, "Keep it on," and there is not a thing this side of hell the devil can do with you.

I can just see that Roman soldier peeking out of that armor saying, "I am secure in here." And you are.

It is so interesting that He says:

And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace...

I used to think that meant, "Go get your shoes on." Shod feet means travel, so anywhere you go, preach the gospel of Christ, which is the gospel of peace. That is what I thought He meant. I thought I would not be fully clothed in the armor unless I was running around.

That is not what He meant. He meant, "Do not let the devil take your sandals, because you need to shod yourself with the preparation of the gospel of peace." The devil is going to come and try to kill you, so you need to prepare yourself. If you shod yourself with peace, you can stand on any terrain, any kind of ground, anywhere, anytime.

Peace will make it so.

What if I am in India in a back alley watching children starve to death? These things were done for your example. The works I do, you will do also, and greater works than these. He said, "Have faith in God," and nothing shall be impossible to you.

Do you think geography matters with the power? Do you think because you have no natural access to turn to and say, "Would you all send me a bunch of money? I am going under," or no people to raise money off of, or no promises to make in the middle of their half-whipped lives that if they give you a hundred dollars, they will hit utopia - do you think that changes anything?

Geography is not what it is about. If that were the case, you would have no access here because the Bible was written in Jerusalem and the East.

Yet He said:

Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on.

Is not life much more than raiment, the clothing you wear and the food you eat? What is the matter with you getting stuck in that realm?

He said, "Do not even bother to take thought. Take no careful thought for tomorrow. It is full of evil, trust Me. Wars are coming, needs are coming, more starvation, more famine, more earthquakes, and more death. It is coming, my friend. Do not worry about tomorrow. There is enough sufficiency in evil today."

Take no careful, care-filled thought toward tomorrow. You will simply be wasting your time.

The Word of God was not restricted to any generation. There was no geography when He said, "Take no thought." It was written for any child of God in any generation, in any country, who ever lifted the Word and whose eyes feasted on it and said, "I serve a God who is able."

The whole chapter instructs you on things you deal with in everyday life: food and clothing. The first thing He says is, "Consider the lily," the flowers of the field. They are so temporary. Today they are in the field displaying glory and grandeur that would make Solomon cringe.

He said, "Consider them." Meditate on them, worried one. After you consider it, consider what Jesus said:

 | O ye of little faith.

How is it that you have no faith from what? From looking at a lily?

You owe it to yourself to break surface faith. You owe it to every person who ever died before you so this Bible could come to you in a river of blood. You owe it to every red-blooded American who stood up and said, "We will have our freedom of religion," so we can sit here and enjoy computerized programs that lay the Word of God out.

My friend, you are going to be judged for every chapter you read. And that judgment is not bad. It is the standard of reward, unless you read and were not born again. It is not bad.

You will say, "I could not."

He will say, "It says right here you could have."

"But I did not."

"Yes."

You cannot escape it.

He says, "Meditate on the lily. Today it is. Tomorrow it is in the oven. It does not toil. It does not spin. Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these. Not even one."

He says, "Consider the fowls of the air." They tell me there is not enough money in Texas to feed the fowls of the air for a day. Would you like to have their bill? Yet He said they do not sow, they do not gather, and they do not store up in barns.

You want to talk about no works? You want to talk about grace? He said, "Meditate on the fowl. He does not sow. He does not gather. He does not even store up in barns. You think it is based on your sowing and gathering? Your heavenly Father feeds him. Are you not worth so much more, you of little faith?"

He called it little because some of you worry.

Labor to enter into this rest. Is it worth laboring for? Yes.

He went on to say:

 | For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword...

He said, "Labor to enter the rest, because the Word of God is." What qualifies you to enter the rest is the Word of God.

Labor to enter the rest, for the Word of God is. Labor to enter the rest, for the Word of God is. Labor to enter the rest.

"What qualifies me, Jesus?"

The Word of God is quick. It is alive. It is powerful. It is meant to be used by you for what purpose? To enter into the rest.

What He promised the Israelites is as true as what He promises you. There is a place of rest. They could have entered in. If you are full of torment, it is because you have not.

Labor to enter into the rest, for the Word of God is alive and powerful, sharper than any two-edged sword, dividing asunder soul and spirit, joints and marrow, and discerning the intents of the heart.

He would not have said it discerns your innards without telling you this is the sword that goes inward.

For what? He says, "If you bear fruit, I will purge you that you may bear more."

We have a sword that turns inward. Why labor to enter the rest if there were no resistance? Yet He says, "The Word of God is available to you, son. This is what you labor with. Otherwise you are wasting your time."

She is a discernor of the intents of the heart. She is the only qualified agent to take those things out of your heart realm and put those things in that will dictate peace.

It does not matter what you think about it, how good you sing, or how loud you can shout. Those are wonderful. But the Word is the discernor of the intents of the heart. It is the only qualified agent to cut away the fat things that are not God and establish the things that are.

He says there is no creature that is not manifest in His sight. All things are naked and stripped down bare before the eyes of Him with whom we have to do.

It does not matter what a reserved person you are. It does not matter what a private person you are. Your heart is a naked book. You can fool people. You cannot fool God. He will strip you down naked for what purpose? So you can see you, my friend.

You have got it all.

Do you think you have problems? The very next verse says:

For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities...

I get to thinking I am going through something He has not. Listen to me, my friend. As a man, He was acquainted with your griefs. He was touched by the feelings of your infirmities. If you think He does not understand, you had better think again.

Your heart is a naked book. No one but Him knows your progress. He considers progress when you labor to enter into His rest.

The Word of God is alive and powerful, the only qualified agent to divide such a blow that you can walk out in the middle of soul and spirit, look at both halves, and know which one you operate out of. Evidently, until I can deliver that blow and learn to operate out of the spirit, peace will be an elusive thing to me.

Labor to enter into the rest. Part of that is glorifying God and activating grace in the middle of your circumstances.

Your adversary, as a roaring lion, walks about seeking whom he may devour. Resist him steadfast in the faith.

I like the verse before that one even better:

Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.

It is an act of humility. Anybody can be proud. That is unteachable. He resists the proud but gives grace to the humble. God, what a statement. He resists the proud and gives His standing to the humble. He resists the proud and gives His unmerited, unearnable favor to the humble.

Oh, I would sure like to qualify as humble.

Then I take the rest of it:

Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:

Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.

How do I humble myself? By casting the whole of my care over onto Him. He cares for you so He can lavish His care upon you.

What is the lavish process? How do I know when I am receiving His care? He gives grace to you, you humble outfit, and starts exalting you out of your problem.

First of all, He has to get you out from under Satan's jurisdiction:

Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.

How would you like to be out from under his jurisdiction? How would you like to be undevourable? As many inspections as he makes on you day by day, he is still incapable of stopping you.

That is what devour is. He starts with a little cancer and eats your whole life up. He starts with a little poverty and bankrupts you. He starts with a little strife and ruins your marriage. He is the devourer. He enjoys laying under shade for you and eating you a piece at a time.

He is seeking devourable people. I do not want under his authority.

How do I change jurisdiction? Humble yourself under His hand. Become teachable. Turn to what the Word says. It is more than hearing; it is doing.

Be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind...

Why?

...that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

What does prove mean? It is the same thing God did to Abraham when He proved him. He said, "Give Isaac, because, Abraham, I am telling you something. My Word is true. The promises hang on Isaac. My Word is true."

He proved the strength of the covenant to Abraham, and buddy, she held.

What does proving the good, acceptable, and perfect will mean? It means you have undeniable proof that your God reigns in your life, for it has been proven to you once again.

I like that. I really like that.

So He says, "Humble yourself, for your adversary as a roaring lion walks about seeking whom he may devour," throwing inspections for devourable people.

Who cannot be devoured? The person who humbled himself, took transformation to the Word, started proving the Word, and allowed God to lavish His care on him because he has no care. It took him out of Satan's jurisdiction and made him undevourable.

"Well, this is harder than I thought."

That is why He called it labor.

I do not want to wait until circumstances and tribulation are taking me over to do anything. I would rather go to the Word of God, find myself a mountain of need - needs to be met in the kingdom - and then tear hell up and start meeting it.

Then the enemy will throw at me the same things to stop me because I am invading his territory, the same things he would otherwise systematically use to devour me. I would rather provoke the circumstances myself just for the privilege of kicking his teeth out, rather than having it imposed on me.

I am going to impose it on him.

And that, my friends, is what revivals are made out of.